The memo to the CFO: at most two pages

Header
To the CFO, from the staff accountant, date, subject

Opening, readable alone
What the package required and what it changed
The effect on income, on the comparative year and on cash
The recommendation: record some, hold one, do not release yet

The four required matters, each in four parts

Matter	What the records show	Evidence that would settle it	Possible effect and treatment
Tax status			
Leases			
Sales tax			
Opening balances			

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The other matters the records point to, briefly
Cash: confirm the balance with the bank
Inventories: a count, a net realizable value review and a cost study
Later events and going concern, from Requirement 8

The passed items for the CFO's approval
Their total and its share of materiality

The changes to the year-end close
Accrue payroll for the days worked
Review the open accruals every month
Cut revenue off by the delivery date
Accrue the interest every month

The closing recommendation
Record the adjustments the records settle and the reclassifications; record the old accruals once the suppliers' evidence supports it; do not release the package until the four required matters are settled

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The appendix of exhibits: at most three pages, one page for each exhibit

Exhibit 1
The schedule of adjustments with the passed items

Exhibit 2
The matters' numbers

Exhibit 3
The going-concern conditions

Boxes stand for the parts of the memo in the order the requirement gives them; the gray bars stand for text. The two pages and the three exhibits are the limits the requirement sets, and the table of the four required matters is the one the guide's model memo uses.